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Middle Persian Ostraca from South Turkmenistan

by A.B. NIKITIN

Among the numerous finds made by various archaeological expeditions in South Turkmenistan there are several Middle Persian (Pehlevi) ostraca. The first Middle Persian documents from Turkmenia were found in 1904 at Erk-kala, the citadel of Ancient Merv, by the American expedition headed by R. Pumpelly⁽¹⁾. In 1936-1937 A.A. Maruščenko who continued to explore the citadel recovered several fragments of pottery with Arabic, Middle Persian and Sogdian inscriptions⁽²⁾. The greatest part of the epigraphic finds in Merv were made by the South Turkmenian Archaeological Complex Expedition (STACE) of the Turkmenian Academy. Several inscriptions were also found beyond the limits of the Merv Oasis, during the excavations of Ak-depe, a Sasanian castle near the station of Artik (Kaahka region). The palaeography of these documents permits to date them to the 6th-7th centuries, some even to the 8th century⁽³⁾.

Middle Persian ostraca are known not only from finds in South Turkmenistan. Ostraca from Dura-Europos in Northern Mesopotamia are dated in the middle of the 3rd century⁽⁴⁾. To later periods belong documents from Veramin⁽⁵⁾ and from Čal-

⁽¹⁾ R. Pumpelly, *Explorations in Turkestan. Expedition of 1904*, vol. I, Washington 1908, pp. 197-98, pls. 52, 53.

⁽²⁾ S.B. Pevzner, 'O dvuh arabskih azbukah iz raskopok v Merve', *Epigrafika Vostoka*, IX, 1954, pp. 24, 37, fn. 2; V.G. Lukonin, 'Srednepersidskie nadpisi iz Kara-tepe', *Buddijskie peščery Kara-tepe v Starom Termeze*, Moskva 1969, p. 40, fn. 1; A.A. Frejman, 'Sogdijskaja nadpis iz Starogo Merva', *Zapiski Instituta Vostokovedenija*, VII, 1939, p. 296; A.A. Maruščenko, 'Fragment sogdijskoj nadpisi iz Starogo Merva', Manuscript: The Central State Archives of the Turkemenian Republic, F.P.-67, op. 2, d. 72, pp. 39-40.

⁽³⁾ Middle Persian language and script were being used in a business correspondence for about a hundred years after the Arab conquest — see: B.A. Kračkovskaja & I.Ju. Kračkovskij, 'Drevnejšij arabskij dokument iz Srednej Azii', *Sogdijskij Sbornik*, Leningrad 1934, p. 68.

⁽⁴⁾ *Corpus Inscriptionum Iranicarum*, pt. III, vol. 3, portf. 1. *The Parthian and Middle Persian Inscriptions of Dura-Europos*, ed. R.N. Frye, London 1968, pl. XXVII, no. 24; J. Harmatta & Th. Pékárý, 'The Decipherment of the Parsik Ostrakon from Dura-Europos and the Problem of Sasanian City Organisation', *Atti del convegno internazionale sul tema 'La Persia nel Medioevo'* (Accademia Nazionale dei Lincei, Quaderno no. 160), Roma 1971, pp. 467-76; F. Grenet, 'Les Sassanides à Doura-Europos (253 ap. J.-C.). Réexamen du matériel épigraphique iranien du site', *Géographie historique au Proche-Orient*, Paris 1988, pp. 133, 143-44.

⁽⁵⁾ *Corpus Inscriptionum Iranicarum*, pt. III, vol. 4-5, portf. 1. *Ostraca et Papyri*, ed. J. de Menasce,

Tarḥān near Rayy ⁽⁶⁾, also from finds at Kasr-i Abu Nasr in South Iran ⁽⁷⁾. Not long ago an early Middle Persian ostracon has been found at Dal'verzin-tepe, South Uzbekistan ⁽⁸⁾

Reading of Middle Persian cursive texts presents many difficulties. They are written in various cursive scripts which differ considerably from the Book Pehlevi. Forms of some letters and ligatures in the cursive script are almost identical so that often several variants of reading of the same words are to be taken into account.

Most documents are badly preserved, on some we have only initial or only final parts of the lines. All difficulties connected with the reading of such texts have been demonstrated by D. Weber in the case of some ostraca from Veramin ⁽⁹⁾.

The Middle Persian Papyri and parchments from Egypt dating in the short period of Sasanian occupation (619-629) present the closest parallel to the script of the ostraca. These documents preserved in museums and private collections have been studied for a long time, nevertheless many parts of the texts remain obscure ⁽¹⁰⁾.

The study of the Middle Persian ostraca from Turkmenistan was started by V.G. Lukonin who published one of the fragments found in 1937 by A.A. Maruščenko ⁽¹¹⁾. Obviously, he intended to continue this work because several ostraca from the finds of the South Turkmenian expedition have been delivered to the Hermitage Museum at his request. In 1986 V.A. Livšic proposed to entrust the study of Pehlevi ostraca to the author of this article who owes much to his generous help and advice.

At present we know thirty-eight ostraca and fragments with Pehlevi inscriptions, including one inscription on a whole vessel, coming from various finds in South Turkmenistan:

- 1-2. Two ostraca from Erk-kala found in 1904 by R. Pumpelly (together with two inscriptions on sheep's shoulder blades, still undeciphered).
- 3-4. Two ostraca from Erk-kala found in 1937 by A.A. Maruščenko.
- 5-6. Two ostraca from Erk-kala found in 1948 and 1955 by a team of the South Turkmenian expedition.

London 1957, pls. XIII-XXII; D. Weber, 'Zur Interpretation der Pehlevi-Ostraca', *Memorial J. de Menasce*, Louvain 1974, p. 228.

⁽⁶⁾ D. Thompson, *Stucco from Chal-Tarkhan—Eshqabad near Rayy, including illustrations of the excavated ostraca from the same site*, London 1976, pls. XXVI-XXXIV.

⁽⁷⁾ R. Frye, ed., *Sasanian Remains from Qasr-i Abu Nasr. Seals, Sealings, and Coins*, Cambridge, Mass., 1973, p. 102.

⁽⁸⁾ V.A. Livšic & A.B. Nikitin, 'Rannij pehlevijskij ostrak iz buddijskogo hrama v Dal'verzin-tepe', *VDI*, in press.

⁽⁹⁾ Weber, *op. cit.*, p. 228.

⁽¹⁰⁾ D. Weber, 'Pahlavi Papyri and Ostraca', *Middle Iranian Studies*, vol. 16. *International Symposium on Middle Iranian Studies. Proceedings*, Leuven 1984, pp. 25-43.

⁽¹¹⁾ Lukonin, *op. cit.*, p. 40, fn. 1, p. 207, fig. 21.

- 7-14. Eight ostraca from the 'oval building' at Gjaur-kala (site 3) excavated by the STACE in 1953-1954.
15. The inscription on the side of a vessel found in the 'oval building' at Gjaur-kala in 1962.
- 16-18. Three fragments from the Buddhist sanctuary at Gjaur-kala (site 9) excavated by a team of the STACE in 1974-1976.
- 19-33. Fifteen small ostraca from the same Buddhist sanctuary found in 1976.
34. An ostrakon found near the village of Murgab (Murgab region) in 1970.
35. A short inscription engraved on a fragment of a jar found in the middle of 1960s at Ak-depe (Kaahka region).
- 36-37. Two ostraca from the settlement of Ak-depe found in 1975 and 1977.
38. A fragment from Koša-depe found in 1970s.

TRANSLITERATION AND TRANSLATION OF THE DOCUMENTS

1. A fragment of a large storage jar broken in two halves, 19.5 × 13.5 cm and 18 × 13 cm (Fig. 1). Found in 1904 at the central mound of Erk-kala by the American expedition headed by R. Pumpelly. It was brought to St. Petersburg to K.G. Zalemann who identified it as an ostrakon with a late cursive Pehlevi inscription. However, he made no attempt to decipher it. In 1988 this long-forgotten ostrakon was re-discovered in the Oriental Department of the Hermitage Museum (Inv. no. A.1516) and identified with the document reproduced in Pumpelly's report.

Text in two columns; right column:

transliteration	transcription
1. []t(?)	
2. wn'skl	wināhgār (or wināhkār ?)
3. l's PWN zynd'n	rāh pad zēdān
4. W nsng YHYTYWN-yt	ud nihang āwarēd
5. bht	baxt

1. (almost completely washed-out) 2. commission of sins 3. is a way to prison
4. and (it) does not bring much 5. fortune.

left column:

6. gwm'nyk d't wl	gumānīg dād war
7. mgwpt BR' dlwhtn' L'	mowbed be druxtan nē
8. 'lp'[y]lt W YMYTWN-t	abāyēd. ud murd
9. W ZNH mgwGBR'	ud ēn mogmard

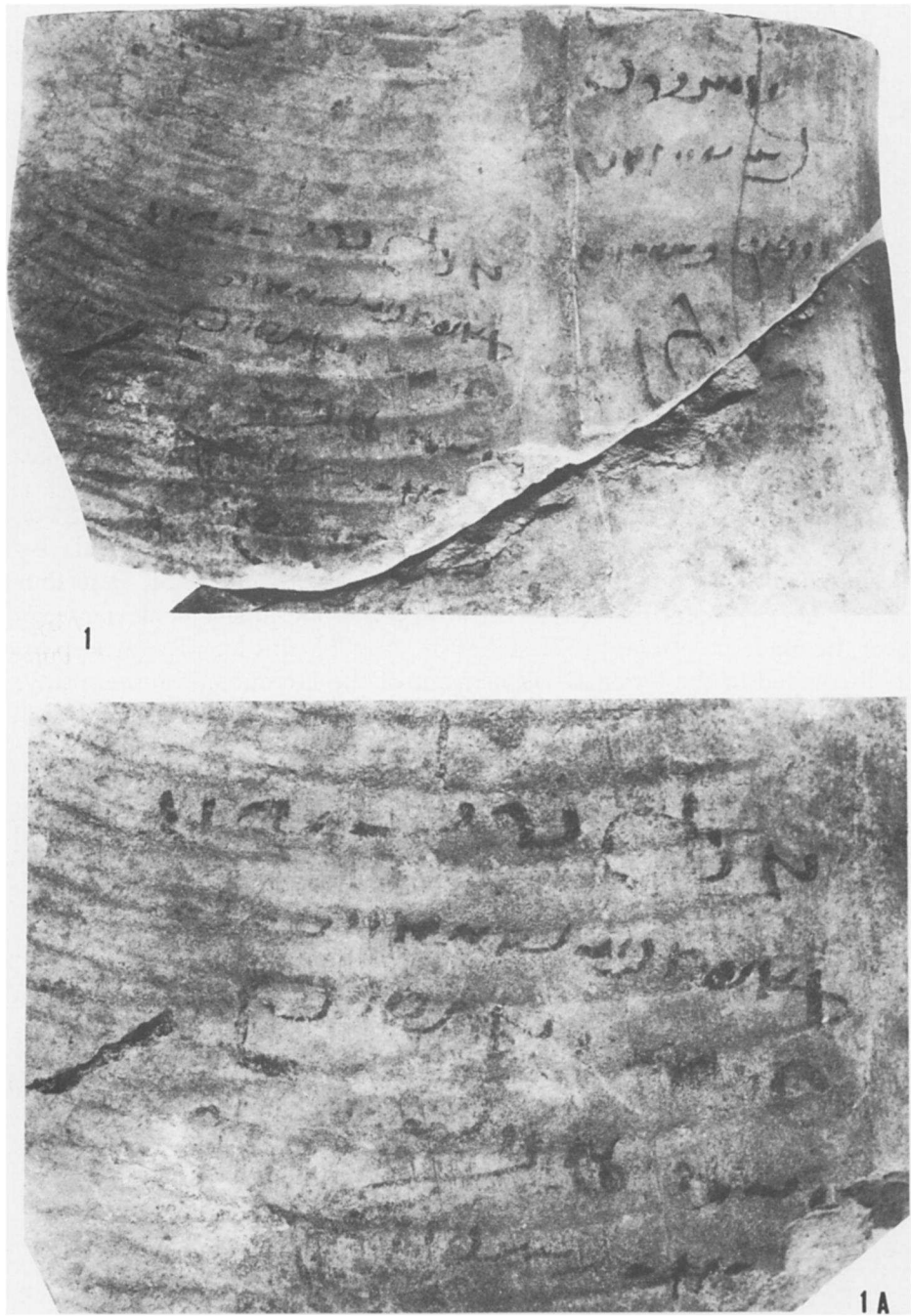


Fig. 1 - From Erk-kala.

- | | |
|------------------------|-----------------------|
| 10. 'YK Y ys/sk(?)[]t | kū ī yask / škast (?) |
| 11. YMRR(WN)-yt | gōwēd |

6. He gave a doubtful oath. 7. But a *mowbed* should not tell lies. 8. And (he) died. 9. But that priest 10. that (he) is ill (?) 11. (he) said.

Commentary: Line 2. *wn'skl* could be interpreted either as 'sinner' (*wināhgār*) or as 'commission of sins' (*wināh-kār*), so it is also possible to translate 'the way to prison is (open) for a sinner'. Line 10 is too badly preserved to propose any definite reading. It is possible to read *yask* 'illness' or *škast* '(he) broke'.

This text is the only one among the ostraca from Turkmenistan which is not dealing with economic matters. It could be a school text, an essay on the sin of perjury, or a draft of some legal document, an accusation of taking a false oath directed against a *mowbed*, Zoroastrian priest of high rank.

2. An ostrakon, 5.5 × 4.5 cm. Found in 1904 at Erk-kala by the American expedition. Seven short lines of cursive Pehlevi inscription. Its present location is unknown. A photograph of the inscription published in the report of the expedition is not clear enough to read the text ⁽¹²⁾.

3. A fragment of a large storage jar, 25 × 15 cm (Fig. 5). Found in 1937 by A.A. Maruščenko at Erk-kala, at the same site which had been explored earlier by R. Pumpelly — the central mound of the citadel. This ostrakon has been published by V.G. Lukonin ⁽¹³⁾ who deciphered the basic text but for the last line containing numerical indications and two additional lines of what he called 'a complicated ligature' above the basic text.

The basic text: 1. *NKSY'KR'* 2. *'twrmtr'* 3. *štly* 4. *200 + 20 + 3 + 3 ZWZN* = *xwāstag harw (ī) Ādur-Mihr-Šahr* — 226 *drahm* 'the whole property (of) Ādur-Mihr-Šahr (is) 226 drachmae'. As for the 'complicated ligature' above the basic text, it is formed by two lines: 5. *'ndk lhyk* 6. *ZHB'* = *andak rahig* 'few slaves', *zarr* 'gold'. One extra line (7) deciphered by V.G. Lukonin contains a personal name *'wḥrmzdgwšnsp* = *Öhrmazd-Gušnasp*.

This text could be a school exercise or a record of someone's property expressed in silver coins (*drahm*), gold (*zarr*) and slaves (*rahig*, literally 'boy, page' used as a common word for 'slave').

4. Another ostrakon found by A.A. Maruščenko in 1937 at the same site (Fig. 2). A fragment of a large vessel, 12 × 6 cm. Traces of six lines on the external surface,

⁽¹²⁾ Pumpelly, *op. cit.*, pl. 53.2.

⁽¹³⁾ Lukonin, *op. cit.*, p. 40, fn. 1.

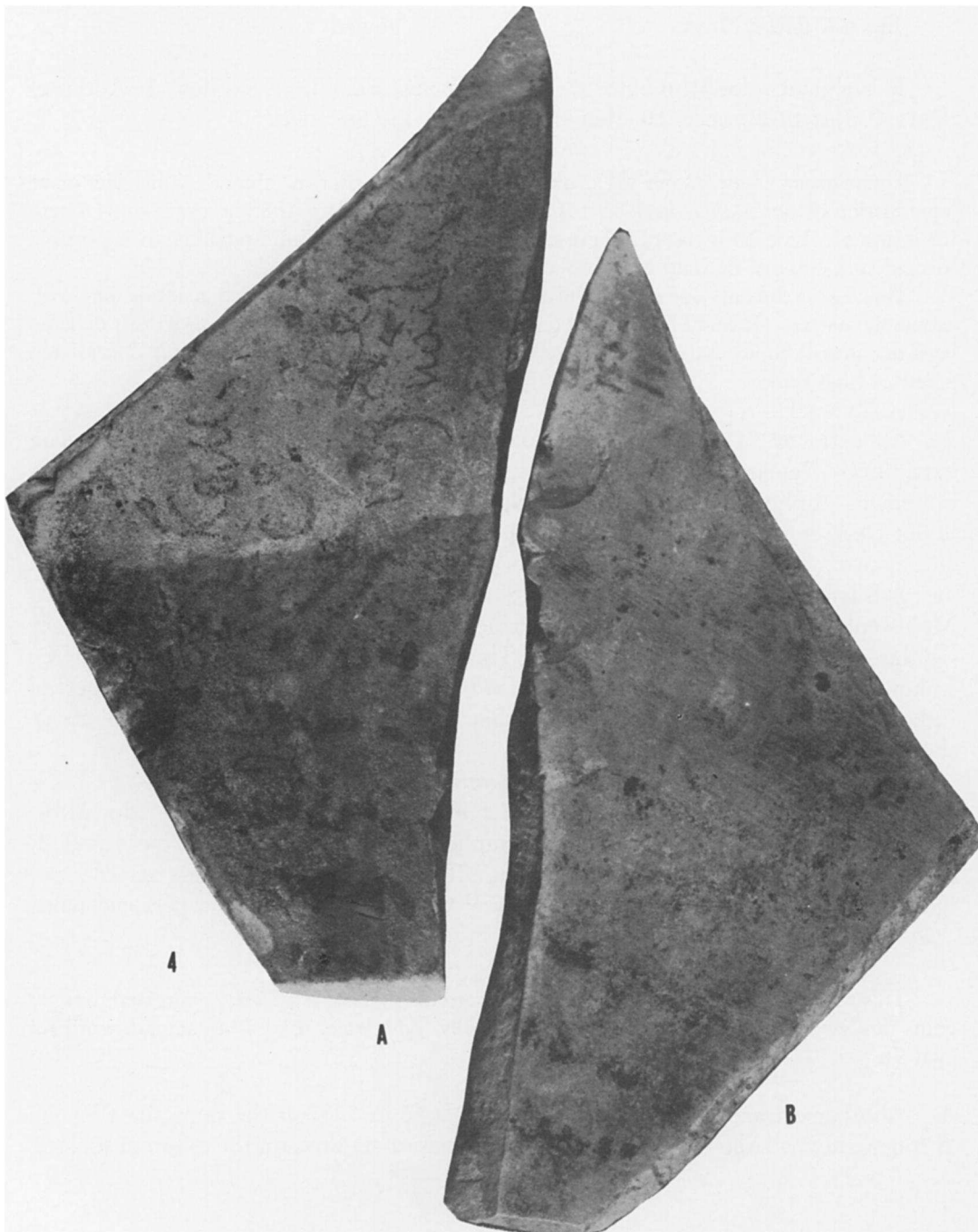


Fig. 2 - From Erk-kala.

traces of eleven lines on the interior surface. The text is illegible, nothing can be said about its contents.

5. A fragment of a large storage jar, 16 × 11 cm (Fig. 3). Found in 1948 at Erk-kala during the excavations carried by a team of the STACE (field number H-10/V). Text in two columns on the external surface of the sherd.

Right column (initial parts of seven lines, four signatures below, the last one almost completely erased):

1.]bw/n[
2. Y'TWN-t
3. (')c't (?) Y d/y/zm[
4. nymk' (?) MN bnd [k'n(?)
5. np('y)k Y yzdkrt
6. YK'YMWN-yt
7. p'ynd'n'n
- signatures:
8. bwlcm(r)'n
9. nzdwnyk (?)
10. ... GDH (?)
11.]]]

Left column (initial parts of 7 lines):

12. l/zld/g/y[
13. B'YH̄W[N-
14. d/gln/wh
15. k/n/w'/hn/w'/hn/w ...
16. Y dpyr 'ZLW[N-t
17. ..
18. n/w'/yt[

Commentary: Line 1. Only two letters are preserved. Line 2. Ideogram Y'TWN-t = *āmad* 'came' (or 'came into possession'). Line 3. 'c't = *āzād* 'free, noble'. Line 4. One of the possible reconstructions: *nēmag az bandagān* 'half of the slaves'. Line 5. The reading *np'k* = *nibāg* 'pawn, deposit' is tentative because the term itself is very rare ⁽¹⁴⁾. The reading *npyk* = *nibēg* 'writing, document' is also possible. Line 6. YK'YMWN-yt = *ēstēd*. Line 7. *pāyandānān* — plural of *pāyandān* 'guarantor, surety sponsor' ⁽¹⁵⁾. Signatures of four of these

⁽¹⁴⁾ A.G. Perihanjan, *Obščestvo i pravo Irana v Parfjanskij i Sasanidskij periody*, Moskva 1983, pp. 28, 302.

⁽¹⁵⁾ A.G. Perihanjan, 'Obrazec pehlevijskogo bračnogo kontrakta', *Sovetskaja Étnografija*, 1960, 5, p. 74; Id., *Sasanidskij sudebnik*, Erevan 1973, p. 513.

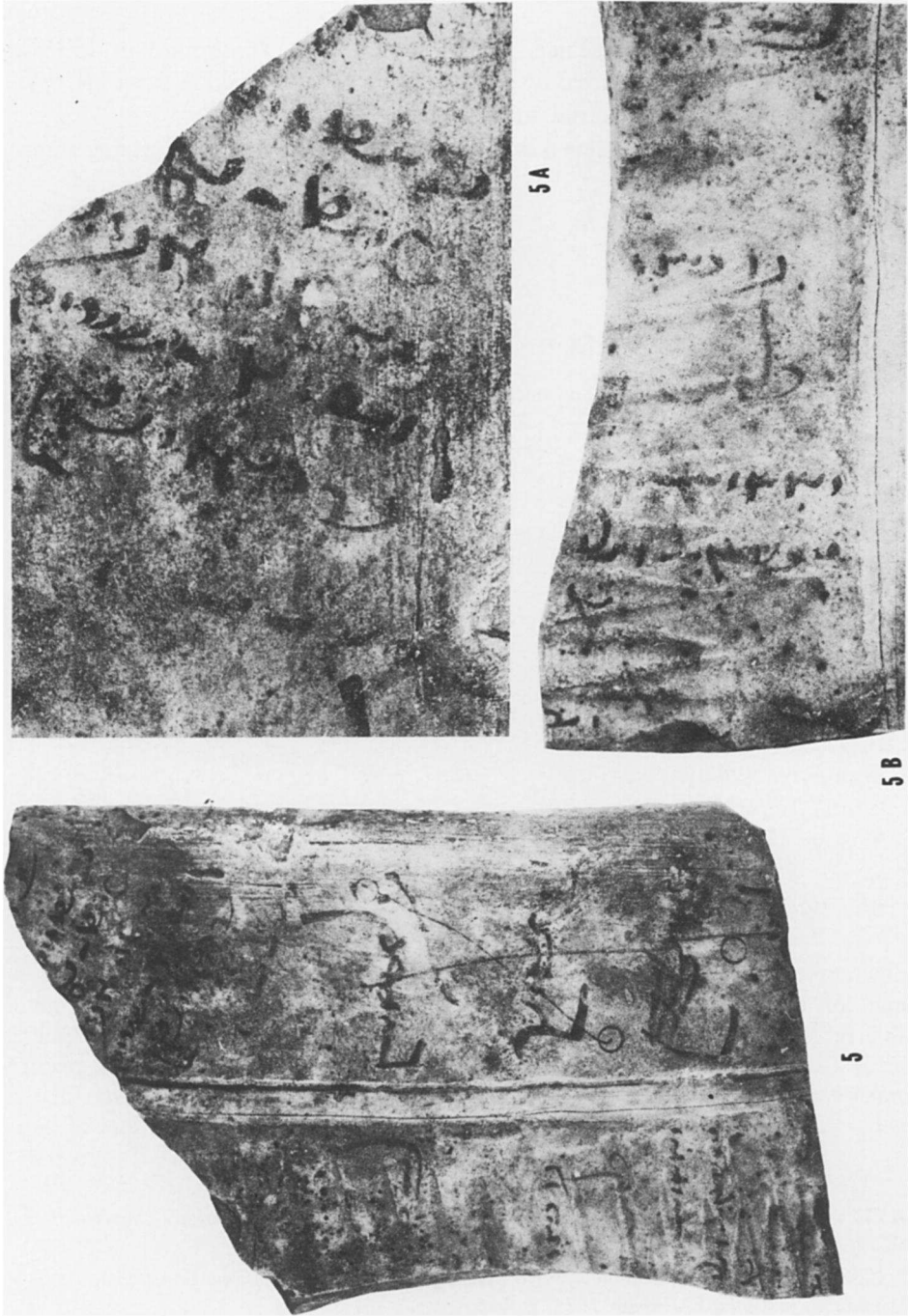


Fig. 3 - From Erk-kala.

guarantors follow: Line 8. *Burzmih(r)ān* — patronym derived from *Burzmihr* ‘one who is exalted by the God Mithra’ — one of the most popular names in Sasanian Iran. Line 9. *nzdwnyk* = *Nazdwanīg* (?). The literal meaning of this name is not clear. The first component could be, probably, *nazd* ‘near’, for the second one we find no satisfactory explanation. Line 10. The first component of the name is not clear, the second one is, obviously, *GDH* = *xwarrah* ‘fortune, glory, splendour’. Personal names with this component were rather common, there are cases of its ideographic representation in seal inscriptions ⁽¹⁶⁾. It is not clear to what extent the text of the right column is connected with that of the left one. Line 12. The reading *zly[n]* = *zarrēn* ‘gold, golden’ is possible. Line 13. *B‘YHW[N-st]* = *xwāst* ‘wanted, acquired’. Lines 14-15 are not clear. Line 16. May be (X...) *ī dibīr šud...* ‘(N.Pr.), scribe, went...’ or ‘(of the) scribe went...’.

Obviously, this ostrakon is a draft of some business document, a contract or a manumission (*āzād-nāmag*) ⁽¹⁷⁾.

6. A fragment of a large storage jar, 23 × 12 cm (Figs. 4-5). Found in 1955 at Erk-kala by a team of the STACE. Five lines of cursive Pehlevi inscription which occupy about 1/4 of the external surface of the sherd:

1. B‘YH(WN)-yt 4 ZWZN 4 [?]
2. d’t 100 + 30/40 + 6 MNW MN t..[
3. d]’t ZWZN 6 ‘L bwlcm[tr] srd’l 5/6
4. d’t L‘YN k’l Y z’yc 100 + []ZK (?)
5. knđ’k Y b’ht (30) + 4 []

1. asked for 4 drachmae (and) 4 [*danags* ?] 2. gave 136 (or 146) drachmae which are from T...(?) 3. gave 6 drachmae to Burzmihr *salar*, 5 (or 6) 4. gave before the making of the horoscope 100 + [drachmae ?] 5. (to) the fortune-teller — 34 (drachmae ?).

Commentary: Line 3. *srd’l* = *sālār* ‘leader, master’, in a more specific sense ‘guardian’ ⁽¹⁸⁾. This title probably belongs to the aforementioned Burzmihr. Line 5. *Kundāg ī bāx* ‘fortune-teller’. The word *kundāg* could mean also ‘magician’ but the second word — *bāxt* ‘fortune, fate’ expounds that in this case not a wizard but a soothsayer is implied. We know several Middle-Persian words for fortune-tellers: *axtarmār* ‘astrologer’, *murwniš* ‘augur’, *kēd* and *kundāg* ⁽¹⁹⁾. The methods used by the last two categories of soothsayers remain unexplained. The word *kundāg* originates from the name of one of the Iranian demons, Kunda, the leader

⁽¹⁶⁾ Ph. Gignoux, ‘Noms propres Sassanides en moyen-perse épigraphique’, *Iranisches Personennamenbuch*, ed. M. Mayrhofer & R. Schmitt, vol. 2, fasc. 2, Wien 1986, p. 188, no. 1036; p. 86, no. 375.

⁽¹⁷⁾ Perihanjan, *Obsčestvo i pravo...*, cit., p. 30.

⁽¹⁸⁾ Perihanjan, *Sasanidskij sudebnik*, cit., p. 520.

⁽¹⁹⁾ *Kār-nāmak ī Ardaxšīr ī Papakān*, ed. and transl. O.M. Čunakova, Moskva 1987, p. 102, fn. 138.



Fig. 4 - From Erk-kala.



Fig. 5 - From Erk-kala.

of sorcerers, in pre-Zoroastrian time — one of the gods of the ancient Iranian pantheon ⁽²⁰⁾. So it is possible that *kundags* were supposed to use some kind of black magic to achieve the knowledge of the future events. Pehlevi literary sources indicate that their activities — *kundāgīh* and the evil sorcery — *jādūgīh* were taken as synonyms, and that both were equally condemned by the Zoroastrian religion ⁽²¹⁾.

This ostrakon presents a list of expenses including sums due to an astrologer and a fortune-teller.

Eight ostraca and one intact vessel with Pehlevi inscriptions were found at Gjaur-kala in 1950s-early 1960s during the excavations of the ‘oval building’ (site 3) carried by a team of the STACE ⁽²²⁾. This site is supposed to be a ruined Christian monastery of the Sasanian time.

7. A fragment of a thin-walled jar, 6.5 × 5.5 cm (Fig. 6). Found in 1953 in the passage connecting rooms 1 and 7 of the ‘oval building’ ⁽²³⁾. Initial parts of seven lines in cursive Pehlevi:

1. m’/yn/w’/yn krt
2. d’t(?) n/w/ktn/w/k P(WN ?) l’t
3. KR’ bwht’ (?)
4. YWM ’(t) [wr’] ?
5. lhyk(?) W ’c’t(?) Y
6.].. 300[
7.]l[

⁽²⁰⁾ E.A. Grantovskij, *Rannjaja istorija iranskih plemen*, Moskva 1970, p. 132; E. West, *Pahlavi Texts*, I (Sacred Books of the East, vol. 24), Oxford 1885, pp. 243-44; A. Christensen, *Essai sur la démonologie iranienne* (Danske Videnskabernes Selskab. Historisk-filologiske Meddelelser, XXVII 1), København 1941, pp. 34, 59. The worship of Kunda by ancient Iranians is testified by the existence of Iranian names with the component *kund-*: *ku-un-da* (M. Mayrhofer, *Onomastica Persepolitana. Das altiranische Namengut der Persepolis Tafelchen*, Wien 1973, p. 182, no. 8.856); *ku-un-da-aš-pi* = *Kundāspa* (W. Hinz, *Altiranisches Sprachgut der Neubenüberlieferungen*, Wiesbaden 1975, p. 154); from the name of Kunda, obviously, originates the Sogdian proper name *kwnt* — in one of the Sogdian rock inscriptions in Pakistan (H. Humbach, ‘Die Sogdischen Inschriftenfunde von oberen Indus, Pakistan’, *Allgemeine und vergleichende Archäologie — Beiträge*, 2, München 1980, p. 226).

⁽²¹⁾ *Bundahishn* (TD.2) — on the natives of Sistan: *harw mardōm az ān giyāg be āyēnd kundāgīh ōh kunēnd az awešan jādūgān sār snēxr tagarg tund ud mayg ōftēd* ‘all men coming from this country practise such witchcraft (*kundāgīh*) that (from the activities) of these wizards (*jādūgān*) snow-fall, violent hail and locusts happen’ (*The Bundahishn, being a facsimile of the TD Manuscript No. 2*, ed. T.D. Anklesaria, Bombay 1908, p. 207, ll. 13-15).

⁽²²⁾ G.Ja. Dresvjanskaja, ‘Oval’nij dom hristianskoj obščiny v Starom Merve’, *Trudy Južno-Turkmenistanskoy arheologičeskoj kompleksnoj ékspedicii*, 15, Ašhabad 1974.

⁽²³⁾ L.M. Rutkovskaja, Field report of 1953 on the works at Giaour-kala. Archives of the STACE, Ašhabad.

Commentary: the remaining text does not make much sense, however, the following interpretations of some lines are possible: Line 1. *m'n'n krt* = *mānān kard* '(he) built houses' or 'Mānēn (N.Pr.) made...'. Line 2. *dād ... pad rād* 'made a gift of ...'. Line 3. *KR' bwḥt* = *harw bōxt* 'saved all (or everything)'. Line 4. *YWM 'twr* = *rōz Ādur* 'in the day Ādur' — a calendar date. Line 5. *rabīg ud āzād ī* 'slave and free of ...'.

All these readings are most tentative.

8. A fragment of a thin-walled vessel, 7.5 × 3 cm (Fig. 6). Found in the 'oval building' in 1953. Field number MGK, P-3, 6-13/IV. Middle parts of five lines:

1. 3 ZWZN (?) YḤBW[N-t]
2. . kh/s/škyn
3. .. W g'wls
4. ...
5.]'L[

Commentary: Line 1. *3 drāhm dād* 'gave three drachmae'. Line 2. *kašk* 'dried butter-milk' or *kāskēn* 'lapis lazuli'? Line 3. *ud gōwars* 'and sorghum'.

This is, probably, some register enumerating agricultural products.

9. A fragment of an ostrakon, 5.5 × 2.5 cm (Fig. 6). Found in 1953 in the 'oval building'. Field number MGK, P-3, 0-21/5. The middle parts of five lines almost erased, the first two contain numerical indications.

10. A fragment of a thin-walled vessel, 8.5 × 4.5 cm (Fig. 6). Found in 1954 in the 'oval building' (24). Initial parts of five lines:

1. Y(?) ...st/p
2. d'tḥwm'/yn
3. Y ḥw'lyn'n
4. mzdck' Y dwš'lm
5. Y l(')tk'

Commentary: Line 1. The text is damaged, only two last letters are seen. Probably, there was a personal name. Line 2. *Dādhōmān* — a patronym or *Dādhōmēn*, hypocoristic from *Dādhōm*. In both cases the literal meaning of the name is 'created by the deity Hōm' (compare to the Old Persian *hwmdt* = *Hauma-dāta* in the Aramaic texts of the 5th century B.C. from Egypt and in the Aramaic inscriptions on ritual objects from Persepolis). Names with the component *hom* occur, though not frequently, in several inscriptions of the Parthian and

(24) Archives of the STACE, Album of 1954.



Fig. 6 - From Gjaur-kala.

Sasanian periods ⁽²⁵⁾. Line 3. *Xwarēnān* ‘son of Xwarēn’. The name, obviously, derives from *xwar* ‘sun’, but for some reason it is inscribed with a long vowel: *xwār* (compare to *hw’rd’t* on a Sasanian seal from the collection of Pirouzan ⁽²⁶⁾). Line 4. *Mazdak* — this name originating from the name of the supreme deity Ahura-Mazda was rather popular in Sasanian Iran. *Dōšāram[īg]* — from *dōšāram* ‘love, dear’. Line 5. *ī Radāg* — this patronym derives either from *rad* — the title of a Zoroastrian priest (‘spiritual chief’) or from *rād* ‘generous’.

The ostracon presents a list of personal names but gives no indications of its purpose.

11. A fragment of an ostracon, 5 × 4.5 cm (Fig. 6). Found in 1954 in the ‘oval building’. Final parts of four lines:

1. ...
2.]p(?)h/st’n 3 YHB(?)
3. . dyw’npt(?) ..
4. .. plm’t’l

Commentary: Line 1. Only the lower elements of three letters remain, obviously of the same ideogram or abbreviation which is repeated below. Line 2. The reading *š]pst’n* = *šabestān* ‘harem’ is possible. It is followed by a numerical indication — 3 and by some abbreviation, probably, an abbreviated form of the ideogram *YHBWN-t* = *dād*; in the ostraca from Veramin it has a similar shape ⁽²⁷⁾. Line 3. *dyw’npt* = *dēwānbēd* ‘chief of the chancery’ (if the reading is correct). From literary sources we know one more Pehlevi term designating some similar office — *dēwānbān* ⁽²⁸⁾. It is followed by another abbreviation of ideogram of obscure meaning. Line 4. One more abbreviation, may be *HS* = *māy* ‘wine’, or a distorted form of *YHBWN-t*; then the word *framādār* ‘commander, ruler’ (‘he, who gives orders’).

A supposition can be made that this ostracon contained a register of expenses of some Sasanian official and his retinue.

12. A small fragment of an ostracon (Fig. 6). Found in 1954 in the ‘oval building’. Remnants of two lines ⁽²⁹⁾.

13. A fragment of a jar (the root of a handle), 9.5 × 7 cm (Fig. 6). Found in 1954 in the ‘oval building’. Seven short lines in cursive Pehlevi:

⁽²⁵⁾ Gignoux, *op. cit.*, p. 98, nos. 437-443; p. 99, no. 456; Ph. Gignoux, *Glossaire des inscriptions Pehlevies et Parthes*, London 1972; I.M. D’jakonov & V.A. Livšic, *Dokumenty iz Nisy I v. do n.é. (Predvaritel’nie itogi raboti)*, Moskva 1960, p. 21.

⁽²⁶⁾ Ph. Gignoux & R. Gyselen, ‘Nouveaux sceaux de la collection Pirouzan’, *Studia Iranica*, 7, 1978, p. 42, no. 70.12.

⁽²⁷⁾ Weber, ‘Zur Interpretation...’, *cit.*, p. 229.

⁽²⁸⁾ Perihanjan, *Sasanidskij sudebnik*, *cit.*, A.26,6.

⁽²⁹⁾ Archives of the STACE, Album of 1954.

transliteration	transcription
1. 'lcn' l't MN zl'tw(r) H _g (below)	arzan rād az Zar-Ādur (?) gandum
2. 't/pyn/tm(?)n(?) 4 20 k'l	 4, 20 kār
3. 40 wynwk MNW MN t/nw/nl/k	40 wēnōg kē az ...
4. 'L lšnwm(?) k'l	ō Rašnum(?) kār
5. ywdtk W n'n'n	judāg ud nānān
6. H ₅ 50	māy 50
7. trk 1	tarrag 1

1. millet, gift from Zar-Ādur (and) wheat 2. ... 4 (measures), 20 (measures of) butter 3. 40 (measures of) lentil which is from ... (N.Pr.) 4. to Rašnūm — butter (of) another (sort) and (loafs of) bread 6. wine — 50 (measures) 7. vegetables — 1 (measure).

Commentary: Line 1. Other possible readings of the name: *zlytk* = *Zaridag* (?) or *zlgwn* = *Zargōn* 'golden, green, fresh'. Line 2. The first word is obscure, it must be a designation of some product. Line 3. The last word is, probably, a personal name — *Tūr*, *Tōg*(?) or *Nōg* ⁽³⁰⁾. Line 4. *Rašnūm* or *Rašnōm* < *Rašn-šnōm* (?) — the name of the deity *Rašn* + *šnōm* < av. **xšnaoma* 'satisfaction' ⁽³¹⁾.

This ostrakon contains a list of agricultural products. Since there is a supposition that the 'oval house' was a Christian monastery it might be a register of supplies received by the community.

14. A fragment of an ostrakon, 6.5 × 5 cm (Fig. 6). Found in 1954 in the 'oval building'. Traces of final parts of six lines, the text is almost illegible. Lines 1 and 2 — traces of some ideograms or abbreviations. Line 3. *pym* = *pēm* 'milk'(?). Line 4. ... *nwk lwyn* ... = ... *nōg rōyēn* ... '... new, of copper ...'. Line 5. *d't l't*(?) 3 = *dād rād*(?) 3 ... 'made a gift of three ...'. Line 6. Traces of some numerals. All these readings are most tentative.

15. A small round vessel (diam. of the body 17.5 cm, diam. of the rim 10 cm, diam. of the bottom 6 cm, h 16 cm) (Fig. 7). Nine lines of cursive Pehlevi inscribed vertically on its body. Found in 1962 in the 'oval building', room 6 ⁽³²⁾. Its present location is unknown. The photographs of this vessel from the archives of the South Turkmenian expedition are not clear enough to decipher the text.

Several Pehlevi ostraca were found in 1974-1976 during the excavations of the

⁽³⁰⁾ Gignoux, 'Noms propres...', *cit.*, p. 137, no. 698 (*Nog*); p. 169, no. 912 (*Tur-Spand-Gušnašp*).

⁽³¹⁾ *Ibid.*, p. 47, no. 129 (*Ardašīr-šnōm*); p. 162, no. 861 (*Šābuhr-šnōm*).

⁽³²⁾ Dresvjanskaja, *op. cit.*, p. 154, fig. 10; archives of the STACE, Album of 1960.

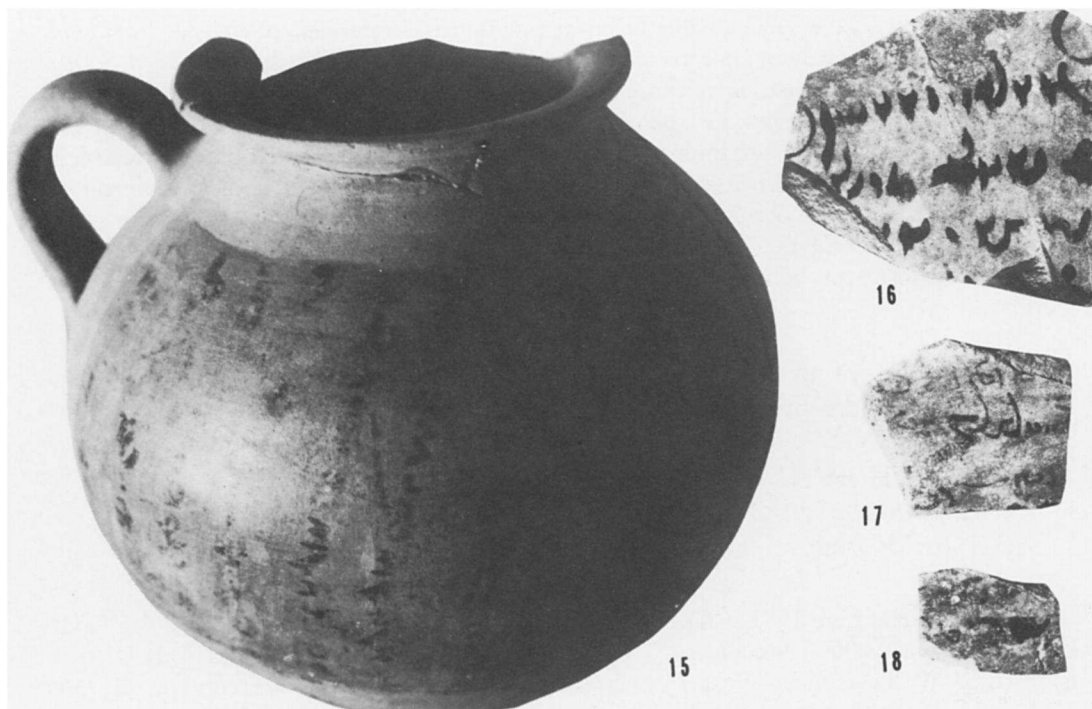


Fig. 7 - From Gjaur-kala.

Buddhist sanctuary at Gjaur-kala (site 9) carried by a team of the STACE under Z.I. Usmanova ⁽³³⁾.

16. A fragment of an ostrakon, 6.5 × 6 cm (Fig. 7). Found in 1974 in the dump from rooms 7-15 in the northern section of the sanctuary. Final parts of three lines, traces of the fourth:

1.]MN gwltk/n[’/y]n ZWZN 4.
2. YWJM(?) dtykl MKBLW N-t MN
3. ḥw(?)ḥyt’ ZWZ[N
4.]M[N

1.]az Gurdagēn/ān drahm 4. 2.]rōz(?) dudigar padīr[ift az... 3.]xwāhēd drahm[4.]az [

1.]from Gurdagēn — 4 drachmae. 2.]the other day(?) received (from) [3.] asked for drachmae 4.]from[

⁽³³⁾ Z.I. Usmanova, ‘Raskopki buddijskogo pamjatnika III-VI vv. v Merve’, *Uspehi sredneaziatskoj arheologii*, 4, Leningrad 1979, pp. 66-67, fig. 21 (plan of the sanctuary).

Commentary. Line 1. The name Gurdagēn or Gurdagān derives, obviously, from *gurd* 'hero'. Line 2. One cannot be sure of the reconstruction of the first word [YW]M = *rōz* 'day'. Days of the Zoroastrian calendar were usually indicated not by ordinal numbers but by their corresponding names, i.e. the names of the deities. It might be, of course, that the words 'the other day' were not intended to indicate any particular calendar date. Circles left by the blunt end of a reed pen at the end of the first line and above it indicate the end of a phrase. Similar circles occur on some other ostraca from Merv (Nos. 5, 34) and in some Pehlevi papyri from Egypt.

This fragment can be a fragment of a promissory note or of some record of debts and credits.

17. A fragment of an ostracon, 4 × 3.3 cm (Fig. 7). Found in 1976 in the dump near room 20 of the Buddhist sanctuary. Middle parts of three lines:

1.]p/t 'LH BYT['
2. d']t' 200 + 20 'N/W yc[nd
3.]wsn'd(?) kt[

Commentary: Line 1. 'LH BYT' = *ōy xānag* 'this house'. Line 2. *dād*(?) 220 ... (and) *ēc[and]* = 'gave(?) 200 ... and a few...'. The meaning of the ligature 'N/W (less likely H̄N/W) is obscure. We have come across a similar ligature in the text of the ostracon No. 11, line 3. It must be some ideogram or abbreviation. Line 3. *wsn'd*(?) = *wasnād* 'for, on account of'. The second word is, possibly, *ktk*' = *kadag* 'house, family'.

18. A small fragment, 2.8 × 2 cm (Fig. 7). Found in 1976 in the Buddhist sanctuary, room 21. The middle parts of two lines: the first one is illegible, of the second one two words survived: *y/dtk'* *mlw/k*. The second word can be an ideogram — *MLK*' = *šāh* 'king' or *MLKT*' = *bāmbišn* 'queen' or *mlw*' = *Merv*, the name of the city.

Fifteen small ostraca were found in 1976 in one heap in room 20 of the Buddhist sanctuary. They present fragments of a single thin-walled vessel. Each fragment has one or two short lines in cursive Pehlevi. Their disposition shows that they were inscribed after one or two large sherds had been broken into many pieces (if we put together several fitting fragments we shall see that all these inscriptions run in different directions). Each inscription contains a proper name or a proper name and a patronym. The circumstances of the find testify that at the time when the ostraca were left on the floor the sanctuary had been already abandoned and was half-ruined, the floor covered with sand and debris. We may suppose that some people came to the deserted shrine to draw lots (to what purpose — we shall never know). They picked up a fitting sherd and broke it into small pieces and on each one of them inscribed their names. When the lots had been drawn they left these ostraca on the floor. Finds of coins show that the sanctuary functioned till the end of the 6th century (the latest coins

belong to Husro I, 531-579). So the most probable date for these ostraca should be the first half of the 7th century.

19. An ostrakon, 2.9 × 2.1 cm (Fig. 8). Two lines in cursive Pehlevi: 1. *plḥwz/d't* 2. *Y tws(')n/k* = Farrozzād (or Farroxdād) son of Tos (or Tošāg). The name Farrozzād 'happily born' is rather common in the Sasanian anthroponymics. The patronym Tošāg or Tošān of obscure meaning is formed by the component *tos* which occurs in some other Middle Persian names ⁽³⁴⁾.

20. An ostrakon 4 × 2.8 cm (Fig. 8). Two lines: 1. *bwḥt' Y* 2. *'ḥmn/wk* = Bōxt ī Hamōg. The name Bōxt 'saved' — from the verb *bōxtan* 'save, redeem' is rather common ⁽³⁵⁾. The meaning of the patronym is not so obvious but the reading *Hamōg* 'similar, equal, twin' is the most probable one. Several Iranian names with the component *ham* are known from various inscriptions of the Sasanian period ⁽³⁶⁾.

21. An ostrakon, 2.2 × 2.2 cm (Fig. 8). One line: *swc/z/lyn'*. The most probable reading — *Sōzēn* 'burning', from the verb *sōxtan* 'burn' ⁽³⁷⁾. Another variant, if we take the third letter for *l* — *Surēn*.

22. An ostrakon, 3.5 × 3.5 cm (Fig. 8). One line: *d/gln/wd(m)'n*. V.A. Livšic proposed the reading *glwdm'n* = *Garōdmān* 'Paradise' (Av. *Garō.dāmāna*). This name has never occurred before in Middle Persian inscriptions.

23. An ostrakon, 5.3 × 2.8 cm (Fig. 8). One line: *GDHwm'n*[d? Probably, *Xwarrahōmand* 'glorious, fortunate'.

24. An ostrakon, 4.5 × 3.5 cm (Fig. 8). Two lines: 1. *ḥwn Y* 2. *nwtb'n* = *Hūn* (or *Xon*) ī *Nōdbān*. The name *Hūn*, probably, derives from the ethnonym *Hunn*. The patronym is formed by the component *nōd* of obscure meaning which occurs in some other Middle Persian names (*Nōd-Ādur*, *Nōdag*) ⁽³⁸⁾, and by the suffix *-bān* 'keeper, -guardian'. In most Middle Persian texts this suffix was transcribed as *-p'n*, not *b'n*, but such deviation from historic orthography under the influence of the actual pronunciation of the Late Sasanian time seems quite possible.

25. An ostrakon, 3.5 × 2 cm (Fig. 8). One line: *krtyl'n* = *Kirdirān* — a patronym

⁽³⁴⁾ Gignoux, 'Noms propres...', *cit.*, p. 168, no. 910.

⁽³⁵⁾ F. Justi, *Iranisches Namenbuch*, Marburg 1895, p. 490.

⁽³⁶⁾ Gignoux, 'Noms propres...', *cit.*, p. 95, nos. 429-433.

⁽³⁷⁾ Justi, *Iranisches...*, *cit.*, p. 306 (*Sōz*, *Sōzan*, *Sōzanī*, *Sōzī*).

⁽³⁸⁾ Gignoux, 'Noms propres...', *cit.*, p. 136, nos. 671-697.

or a patronymic name derived from the name Kirdir. We find various transcriptions of this name in Middle Persian inscriptions: *kltyl*, *krtyr*, *krtyl* ⁽³⁹⁾.

26. An ostrakon, 3.6 × 1.8 cm (Fig. 8). One line: ..*n/w'l'* [. Illegible. Obviously, also some personal name.

27. An ostrakon, 4.2 × 3.2 cm (Fig. 8). Two lines: 1. *k]*'*mk l Y* 2. *wḥl'n'* = *Kāmkār ī Wabrān*. The name *Kāmkār* — 'powerful, master' ⁽⁴⁰⁾. The patronym derives from the name of the god of victory — *Warahrān*, *Wahrām*. Its transcription is somewhat different from the accepted orthography.

28. An ostrakon, 4.5 × 2.3 cm (Fig. 8). Two lines: 1. *k'*'*mk'l Y* 2. *s's(')n* = *Kāmkār ī Sāsān*. The same name as on the previous ostrakon. The theophoric patronym *Sāsān* occurs in several Middle Persian inscriptions including inscriptions on seals ⁽⁴¹⁾.

29. An ostrakon, 3 × 2.5 cm (Fig. 8). Two lines: 1. *thwnd'n/t (Y)* 2. *d'tḥly/ww'(?)* = *Tarundān* (or *Tarundād*) (*ī*) *Dād-Harē/ōw*. The name, probably, derives from *tarun* 'young' (compare *Taruniy* on a seal from the Hermitage ⁽⁴²⁾) with the suffix *-dān* 'one who is in possession of youth'. The patronym is less clear, it could mean 'created by (the river) *Harēw*' i.e. by the *Herirud* (*Teḡen*) — *ḥlywḥwt* or *ḥlwḥwt* in Pehlevi transcription, a name quite appropriate for a native of North Khorasan.

30. An ostrakon 3 × 2.7 cm (Fig. 8). Two lines: 1. *slw Y* 2. *ḥ/z(y)k/wn/wl/d'/yn*. The name *slw* = *Sraw* 'glory' ⁽⁴³⁾ (less probable — *Sarw* 'cypress'). The patronym can be deciphered as *ḥwnd'n* = *Xwandān* 'sunny, bright' (from Av. *hwar/hwan* with suff. *dān*), or as *zykwlyn* = *Zīk-Warēn*. Both components are represented in Sasanian antroponymics; the meaning of *zyk*, *zydkey* is unknown ⁽⁴⁴⁾, *Warēn* originates, probably, from *war* 'oath, ordeal' ⁽⁴⁵⁾.

31. An ostrakon, 3.5 × 2.8 cm (broken in two halves) (Fig. 8). One line: *s'sn'* = *Sāsān*.

32. An ostrakon, 3.8 × 2.9 cm (broken, one fragment is missing) (Fig. 8). Two lines: 1. *m'ḥd't Y* 2. *]sk* = *Māhdād ī [...]**sag*. The theophoric name *Māhdād* — 'created by the god *Mah*'.

⁽³⁹⁾ *Ibid.*, p. 105, no. 497.

⁽⁴⁰⁾ Justi, *Iranisches...*, *cit.*, p. 154.

⁽⁴¹⁾ Gignoux, 'Noms propres...', *cit.*, p. 156, no. 827.

⁽⁴²⁾ *Ibid.*, p. 166, no. 894.

⁽⁴³⁾ *Ibid.*, p. 159, no. 847; p. 100, nos. 465, 466.

⁽⁴⁴⁾ *Ibid.*, p. 195, no. 1086.

⁽⁴⁵⁾ *Ibid.*, p. 175, no. 950.

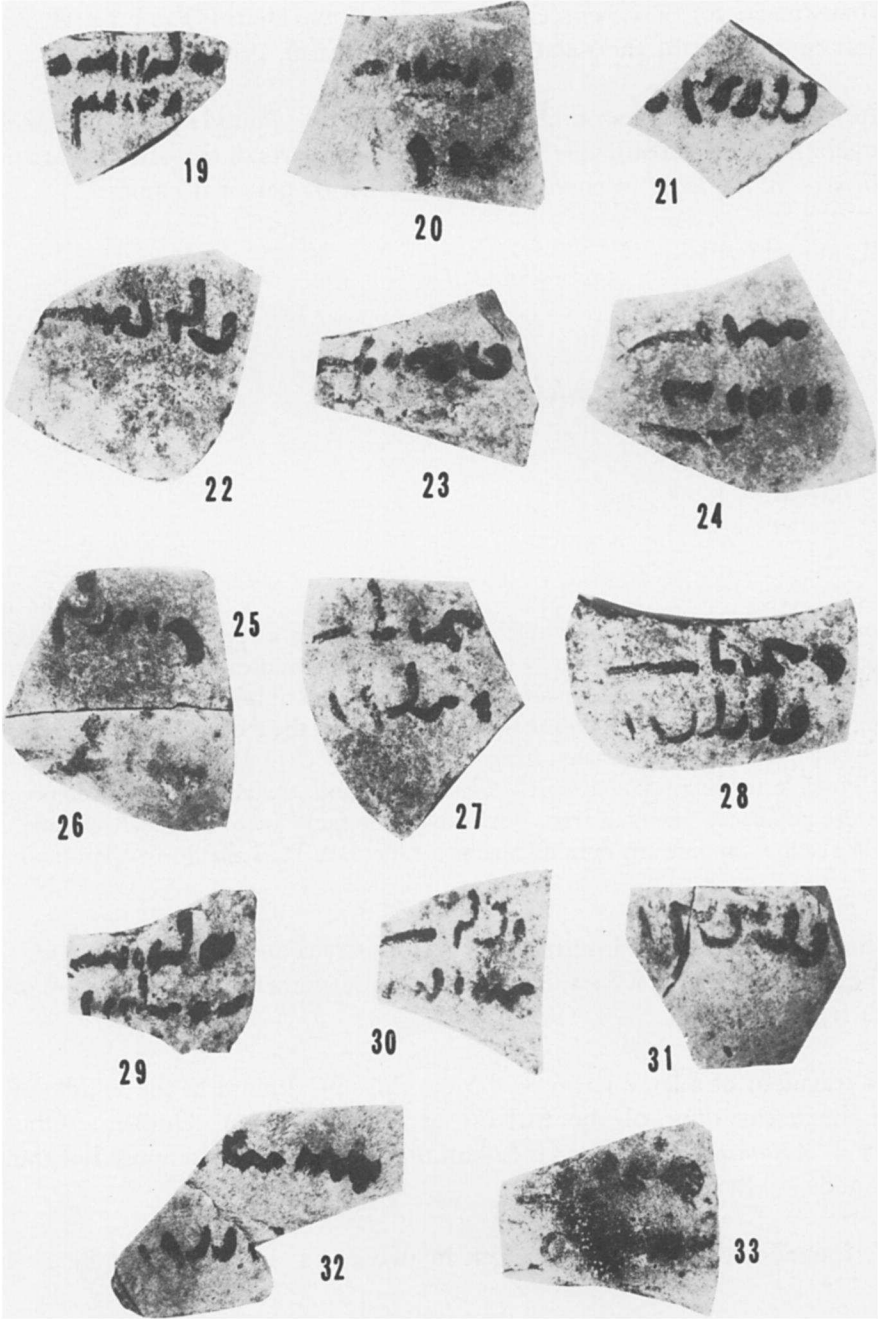


Fig. 8 - From Gjaur-kala.

33. An ostrakon, 3.5 × 2.5 cm (Fig. 8). Traces of two lines: 1. *thm* [] *Y* 2. *h(?)* [] *'n*. The first component of the name — *Tahm* ‘powerful, brave’.

34. A fragment of an ostrakon, 9.5 × 5.5 cm (Fig. 9). Found in 1970 near the village of Murgab (Murgab region). The left and the lower parts of the ostrakon are missing. Initial parts of ten lines in cursive Pehlevi, a list of personal names:

1. *np wh(w) [s]l[*
2. *Y nhwst(?) c[*
3. *bwlc' Y y'knt'n*
4. *y'knt' Y k'mk'l'n*
5. *Y wyhw/klt (or wyhw/klyk)*
6. *p'/hh/s[*
7. *p'/hh/s[*
8. *pylwc[*
9. *pylwc[*
10. *Y[*

Commentary: Line 1. A circle left by the blunt end of a reed pen marks the beginning of the line. The reading: *np whwsl* = *nab Wehsar* ‘the grandson Wehsar’ or ‘the grandson of Wehsar’ is tentative. A similar name occurs in a seal inscription ⁽⁴⁶⁾. Line 2. *ī naxut c[ak?]* ‘of the first document?’. Line 3. *Burzak* — a hypocoristic of the theophoric name *Burz* ‘exalted’. The patronym *Yākandān* originates from *yākand* ‘ruby’ ⁽⁴⁷⁾. Line 4. *Yākand ī Kāmkārān*. Line 5. Possible readings: *Wehwarīg*, *Wehkarīg*, *Wehkard*. Names with the component *weh* ‘good’ were popular in Sasanian Iran. Lines 6-7. The same word, obviously a name, repeats twice. We cannot propose any definite reading. Lines 8-9. The name *Pērōz* ‘victorious’ repeats twice.

Three Middle Persian inscriptions — two ostraca and an engraved one — come from the site of Ak-depe, a Sasanian castle and a settlement near the station of Artik, Kaahka region.

35. A fragment of a large jar, 6 × 4.5 cm (Fig. 9). Found in the middle of 1960s during the excavations of the fortress of Ak-depe by A. Gubaev. One word: *lšnmt(r)* = *Rašnmihr* (read by V.G. Lukonin), a proper name composed of the names of two gods — *Rašn* and *Mihr*.

36. A fragment of a large jar (broken in two parts, 19 × 19 and 11 × 10 cm)

⁽⁴⁶⁾ *Ibid.*, p. 181, no. 989.

⁽⁴⁷⁾ Justi, *Iranisches...*, *cit.*, p. 144.

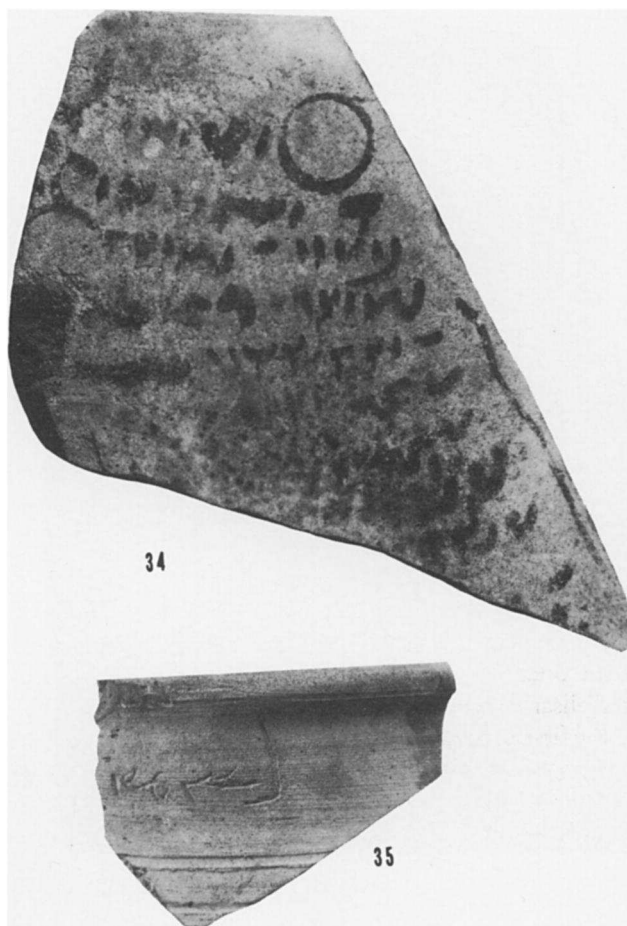


Fig. 9 - From Murgab (34) and Ak-depe (35).

(Fig. 10). Found in 1975 at the settlement of Ak-depe ⁽⁴⁸⁾. Final parts of six lines in cursive Pehlevi:

1. h̥lws]p whšt'
2. h̥ll[w]sp' whšt'
3.]'/sc/p'lyt' ŠM
4.]. BRH 'p'n lt' nwydnd
5.](')yl'n/k MT'.
6.]h̥lwsp' whšt'

⁽⁴⁸⁾ A. Gubaev, 'Zamok Ak-depe u Artyka v svete novyh raskopok', *Uspehi sredneaziatskoj arheologii*, 4, Leningrand 1979, p. 65, fig. 20b.

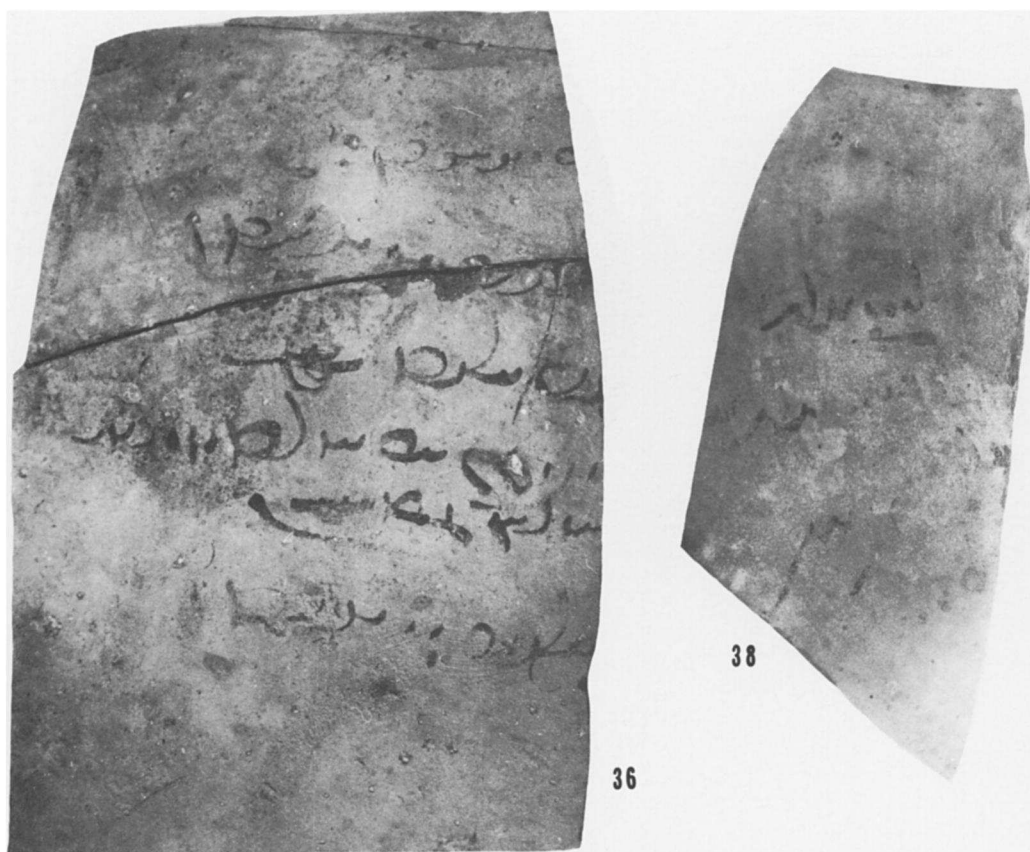


Fig. 10 - From Ak-depe (35) and Koša-depe (38).

Commentary: Lines 1, 2 and 6 contain the formula: *harwisp wabišt* 'all the best'. Line 3. The most likely reconstruction: *'ps]p'lyt' ŠM* = *abespārēd nām* '(he) committed the name (= gave the name?)'. The reading *'c'lyt'* = *āzarēd* 'injured' is less probable. Line 4. *pus Ābān rad niwēyend* '... son (of) Ābān announced (or 'consecrated' — 3rd Plural)'. *Ābān* — a theophoric patronym ⁽⁴⁹⁾, the proper name of this person who held the office of *rad* 'spiritual chief' is missing. The verb *nwydnd* — 3rd person plural of *niwistan* 'announce, consecrate' — obviously, several persons who announced or consecrated something were mentioned in the lost part of the text. Line 5. *]- (Ē)rān* — probably, a toponym, the last component of the name of a *deb*

⁽⁴⁹⁾ Gignoux, 'Noms propres...', *cit.*, p. 25, no. 1, also nos. 4, 5, 7, 15, 16.

(MT') 'village, settlement' ⁽⁵⁰⁾. The stroke at the end of the line, obviously, marks the end of the sentence.

This fragment is, certainly, not an economic document. It can be a draft of some letter concerning religious matters or a dedicational inscription.

37. The bottom of a jar (diam. 12.5 cm) (Fig. 11) found in 1977 in the Zoroastrian sanctuary excavated at the site of Ak-depe ⁽⁵¹⁾. Seventeen lines of a cursive Pehlevi inscription on its exterior side. The handwriting is very unclear, the text is half washed-out.

1. y'tk' z'dst'
2. W 'YK y'nd't plm'(d)yt
3. b(')ht' ZK W k/n(m)[](y)k 1
4. knyck' YHWWN-t 'h/z[](1)
5. W 'm'l
6. y/sw/n[]'h[]d't (?)
7. []
8. []
9. k'y[]
10. 3 ZWZN l't lsynyt (?) []
11. []knyk(?)
12. krt d/gl[]'[] gwhlk (?)
13. n'n 2 d't' W 3 + 3 (mdy ?)
14. 'lt Hg W dlwn(?) [l'd ?]
15. W p(l)m'n'n(?) MNW ...
16. hwd'k'(?)
17.

Commentary: Line 1. *jādag zāst* '(he) demanded a share'; *jādag* 'portion, share', Av. *yāta-*, Parth. *y't* (in the parchment from Avroman, also in the Pehlevi Psalter) ⁽⁵²⁾. Line 2. *ud kū Yāndād(?) framāyēd* 'and that Yandad orders that...'. The name Yāndād (if the reading is correct)

⁽⁵⁰⁾ Ph. Gignoux, *Catalogue des sceaux, camées et bulles sasanides de la Bibliothèque Nationale et du Musée de Louvre*, II, Paris 1978, pl. XI, nos. 4.49, 4.50; Id., 'Nouveaux toponymes sassanides', *JA*, CCLXII 3-4, 1974, p. 303; Ph. Gignoux & R. Gyselen, 'Sceaux Sassanides de la collection M.I. Mochiri', *Pad Nām ī Yazdān. Travaux de l'Institut d'études iraniennes*, vol. 9, Paris 1979, p. 108, no. 00.2; J. Marquart & G. Messina, *A Catalogue of the Provincial Capitals of Ērānšahr*, Roma 1931, § 54.

⁽⁵¹⁾ A. Gubaev & S. Loginov, 'Altar ognia na poselenii Ak-depe', *Pamjatniki Turkmenistana*, I/23, Ašhabad 1977, p. 22. The find of the ostrakon is not mentioned in this publication. All information on the circumstances of its find we owe to S.D. Loginov.

⁽⁵²⁾ F.C. Andreas & K. Barr, 'Bruchstücke einer Pehlevi-Übersetzung der Psalmen', *Sitzungsberichte der Preussischen Akademie der Wissenschaften*, 1933, 1, p. 131.



Fig. 11 - From Ak-depe.

probably, derives from the Old Persian *yāna-dāta ‘created by the grace (of a deity)’⁽⁵³⁾. Compare also Middle Persian names with the component *gyān* ‘soul’⁽⁵⁴⁾. Line 3. *baxt ān ud...* ‘this part and...’. Line 4. *kanīzag bud* ‘a girl (a slave-girl) was...’. Line 5. *ud āmār* ‘and calculation’ (?). Lines 6-9 are illegible. Line 10. *3 drahm rād rasēnēd* ‘brought 3 drachmae as a gift’. Line 11. *kanīg* ‘a girl’(?). Line 12. *kard* ‘(he) made’. The last word, slightly below the line, could be read *gōbrag* ‘substance, nature, jewel, stock’. Line 13. *nān 2 dād ud 6 māy* ‘gave two (loafs of) bread and six (measures of) wine’. Line 14. *ard gandum ud drōn(?)* ‘flour, wheat and consecrated bread (?)’ (or ‘for the sake of *drōn*’ — *drōn*, consecrated bread or a religious ceremony where this bread is used).

In spite of all difficulties in reading this half-washed text one can guess that this ostracon presents a draft of some business letter composed, probably, by a priest of the Fire Temple where this document has been found. A clay bulla with traces of a cord but without any seal impressions was found on the floor of the same room by the altar. It is possible that the text was instantly re-written on some other material (parchment) and sealed.

38. A fragment of an ostracon, 16 × 7 cm (Fig. 10). Found in 1970s at Koša-depe by V.N. Pilipko. Traces of five lines:

- 1-2. illegible
3. 20 + 2 HLY’
4. HLY’
5. .. 3 + 3.

Commentary: the ostracon contains some numerical indications and an ideogram HLY’ (HLH in the Parthian documents from Nisa) ‘vinegar’. Obviously, it is a registration document connected with wine production.

* * *

The Middle-Persian ostraca from South Turkmenistan though few in number and fragmentary reflect various sides of life in the Northeastern provinces of the Sasanian Empire. They testify that in the 6th-7th centuries most business documents were written in Pehlevi, that personal names, names of various institutes and offices current at that time in what is now South Turkmenistan were of Western Iranian origin.

⁽⁵³⁾ Justi, *Iranisches...*, cit., p. 497; É. Benveniste, *Titres et noms propres en Iran Ancien*, Paris 1966, p. 89 — *Miššiyanna* = Old Pers. **Missa-yāna* ‘faveur de Mithra’.

⁽⁵⁴⁾ Gignoux, ‘Noms propres...’, cit., p. 94, no. 424 — *Gyān-sām*; Ph. Gignoux & R. Gyselen, *Sceaux sasanides de diverses collections privées*, Leuven 1982, pl. XX, no. 33.23 — *y’nydyly* = *Gyān ī dīl(?)*. Compare also *Gyān-abzūd* — Perihanjan, *Sasanidskij sudebnik*, cit., § 70, 9-10.